



ФАКУЛТЕТ ЗА ИНФОРМАТИЧКИ НАУКИ
И КОМПЈУТЕРСКО ИНЖЕНЕРСТВО

The Composition API

Chapter 5

Advanced Web Design

5 Why Composition API?

Motivation:

- Improve scalability in larger apps
- Provide better TypeScript support
- Allow clean grouping of related logic
- Enable logic reuse via composables



5 Options API vs Composition API Structure

The main difference is how logic is organized:

- Options API organizes by feature type (data, computed, methods, etc.)
- Composition API organizes by logical feature grouping (state, logic, watchers belong together)

Options API

- Good for beginners and small apps
- Logic split across sections

Composition API

- Better for scalable and complex applications
- Logic stays together

Options API

vs

Composition API

```
1 <template>
2   <h2>Count: {{ count }}</h2>
3   <button @click="increment">+</button>
4 </template>
5
6 <script>
7 export default {
8   data() {
9     return {
10      count: 0
11    }
12  },
13
14  methods: {
15    increment() {
16      this.count++
17    }
18  }
19 }
20 </script>
21
```

```
1 <template>
2   <h2>Count: {{ count }}</h2>
3   <button @click="increment">+</button>
4 </template>
5
6 <script>
7 import { ref } from 'vue'
8
9 export default {
10   setup() {
11     const count = ref(0)
12
13     function increment() {
14       count.value++
15     }
16
17     return { count, increment }
18   }
19 }
20 </script>
21
```

<script setup> — Even Simpler

Vue provides a shortcut syntax: <script setup> simplifies Composition API syntax.



```
1  <template>
2    <h2>Count: {{ count }}</h2>
3    <button @click="increment">+</button>
4  </template>
5
6  <script setup>
7    import { ref } from 'vue'
8
9    const count = ref(0)
10   const increment = () => count.value++
11  </script>
12
```


State: data() vs ref() / reactive()

Options API



```
1 <script>
2 export default {
3   data() {
4     return {
5       name: 'Vue',
6       author: 'Marko',
7     }
8   },
9 }
10 </script>
11
```

Composition API



```
1 <script setup>
2 import { ref } from 'vue'
3
4 const name = ref('Vue')
5 const author = ref('Marko')
6 </script>
```

Methods

Options API



```
1 <script>
2 export default {
3   methods: {
4     greet() {
5       alert(`Hello from ${this.name}`)
6     }
7   }
8 }
9 </script>
10
```

Composition API



```
1 <script setup>
2 import { ref } from 'vue'
3
4 const name = ref('Vue')
5
6 function greet() {
7   alert(`Hello from ${name.value}`)
8 }
9 </script>
10
```

Computed Properties

- `computed()` creates a reactive derived value based on other reactive state.
- It automatically recomputes only when its dependencies change
- It is cached, so as long as the input hasn't changed, it returns the stored value instantly instead of recalculating.



Think of it as a smart value that updates itself.

Computed Properties

Options API



```
1 <script>
2 export default {
3   data() {
4     return { count: 2 }
5   },
6   computed: {
7     double() {
8       return this.count * 2
9     },
10  },
11 }
12 </script>
13
```

Composition API



```
1 <script setup>
2 import { ref, computed } from 'vue'
3
4 const count = ref(2)
5 const double = computed(() => count.value * 2)
6 </script>
```

Watch

Options API



```
1 <script>
2 export default {
3   data() {
4     return { count: 0 }
5   },
6   watch: {
7     count(newVal, oldVal) {
8       console.log('Changed', newVal)
9     },
10  },
11 }
12 </script>
```

Composition API



```
1 <script setup>
2 import { ref, watch } from 'vue'
3
4 const count = ref(0)
5
6 watch(count, (newVal, oldVal) => {
7   console.log('Changed', newVal)
8 })
9 </script>
```

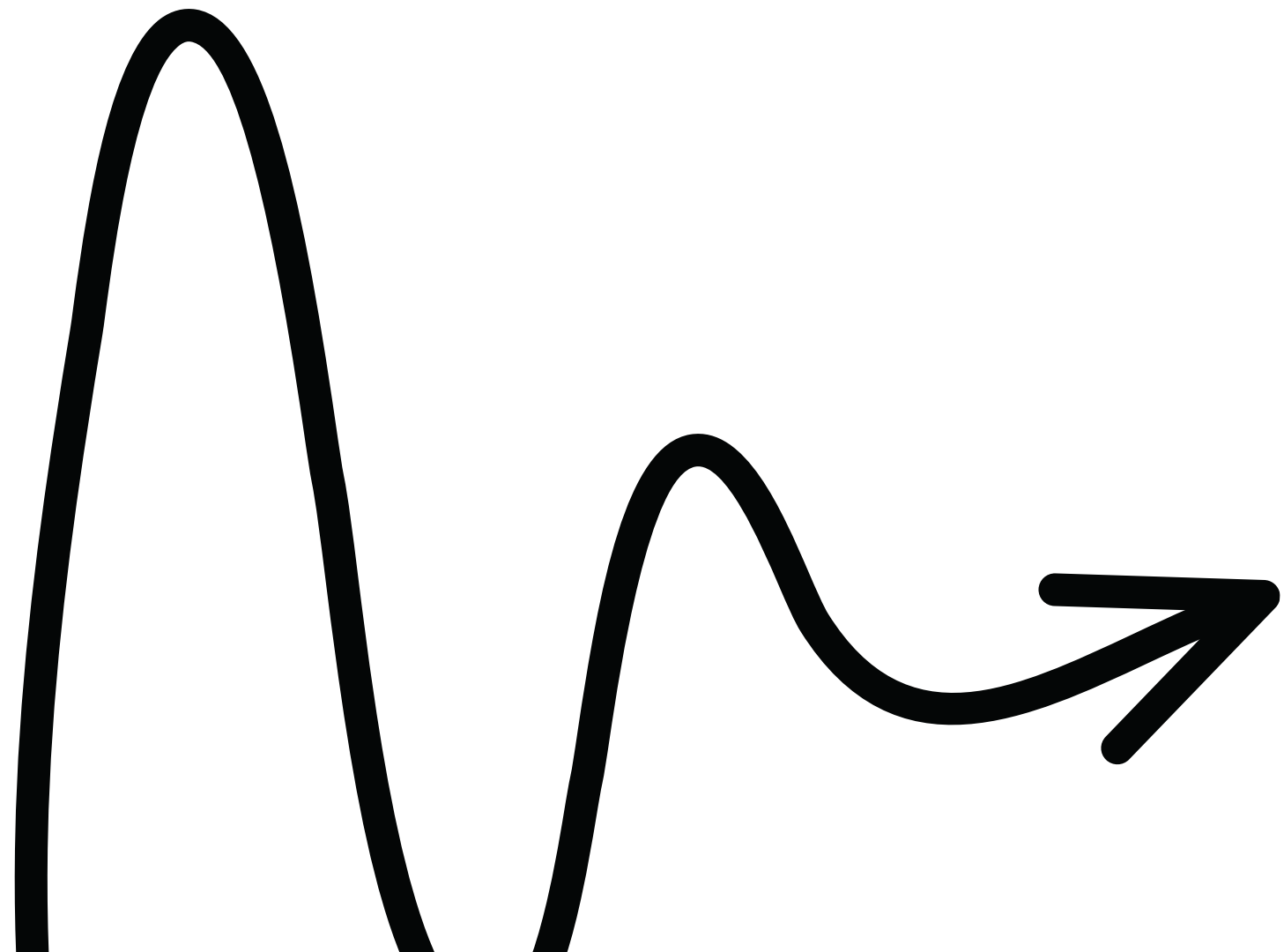
watch

- Used when you want to run logic in response to a specific reactive value changing.
- You explicitly tell Vue what value to observe.
- Useful for side effects: API calls, validation, saving to localStorage, logging, etc.
- Not executed immediately by default – only runs when the watched value changes.



watchEffect

- Runs immediately once, and then again every time any reactive value inside it changes.
- Vue automatically tracks dependencies - no need to specify them.
- Great for debugging, syncing UI with model, reactive APIs, or computed-like logic with side effects.
- No access to `oldValue` (because dependency tracking is automatic).



```
1  watchEffect(() => {  
2    console.log('Count changed:', count.value)  
3    console.log('Name changed:', name.value)  
4  })
```

Full comparison example

```
1  <script>
2  export default {
3    data() {
4      return { count: 0 }
5    },
6
7    computed: {
8      double() {
9        return this.count * 2
10      },
11    },
12
13    watch: {
14      count(val) {
15        console.log(val)
16      },
17    },
18
19    methods: {
20      increment() {
21        this.count++
22      },
23    },
24
25    mounted() {
26      console.log('Mounted')
27    },
28  }
29  </script>
```



```
1  <script setup>
2  import { ref, computed, watch, onMounted } from 'vue'
3
4  const count = ref(0)
5  const double = computed(() => count.value * 2)
6
7  watch(count, (val) => console.log(val))
8
9  function increment() {
10    count.value++
11  }
12
13  onMounted(() => console.log('Mounted'))
14  </script>
```


Lifecycle hooks

Phase	Options API	Composition API
Before mount	beforeMount()	onBeforeMount()
Mounted	mounted()	onMounted()
Updated	updated()	onUpdated()
Unmounted	unmounted()	onUnmounted()

Questions?

